

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1254

By Keisling

A RESOLUTION to honor Will Taylor for his leadership in recovery advocacy and his service to the people of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to honor those citizens whose dedication, leadership, and personal example bring credit to the State of Tennessee and strengthen the well-being of its communities; and

WHEREAS, Will Taylor has earned the respect of colleagues, community leaders, and recovery advocates across the State for his steadfast commitment to supporting individuals and families affected by mental health and substance use disorders; and

WHEREAS, drawing upon both professional experience and powerful lived experience, Mr. Taylor has devoted his career to helping others find hope, stability, and renewed purpose through the promise of long-term recovery; and

WHEREAS, through his work with the Tennessee Department of Mental Health and Substance Abuse Services' Faith Based Initiative and his service in the nonprofit treatment field, Mr. Taylor has contributed to important initiatives that strengthen behavioral health systems and encourage collaboration among State agencies, treatment providers, faith communities, and local organizations; and

WHEREAS, he has demonstrated leadership in the development and operation of addiction treatment programs at both outpatient and residential levels of care, helping ensure that individuals seeking help have access to compassionate and effective recovery services; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Taylor has also been instrumental in fostering recovery-focused community engagement efforts that unite public institutions, faith leaders, nonprofit

organizations, and individuals with lived experience to build stronger recovery support networks throughout the Volunteer State; and

WHEREAS, through these efforts, Mr. Taylor has emerged as one of a growing group of leaders helping shape Tennessee's modern recovery ecosystem—one grounded in collaboration, community engagement, and long-term recovery as essential components of public health and community well-being; and

WHEREAS, his work contributes to the continued advancement of Tennessee's nationally recognized efforts to expand recovery supports and strengthen community-based responses to mental health and substance use challenges; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Taylor's influence extends beyond program development through his work with Recovery Is The New High, an initiative dedicated to breaking the stigma associated with addiction and mental health disorders and promoting recovery through advocacy, education, and community engagement; and

WHEREAS, the phrase "Recovery Is The New High," coined in 2013 by Allen Burnette, has become a powerful message of hope that encourages individuals and communities to recognize the life-changing fulfillment that accompanies long-term recovery; and

WHEREAS, the mission of Recovery Is The New High is to provide education, advocacy, and consultation that foster the development of recovery-oriented practices within communities while encouraging collaboration among those dedicated to helping individuals and families rebuild their lives; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Taylor openly acknowledges that his own life has been transformed through long-term recovery and often credits his faith in God, the encouragement of those who invested in him along his journey, and the strength of community as the foundation for his commitment to serving others; and

WHEREAS, through his leadership, compassion, and dedication to the well-being of others, Will Taylor has become a source of encouragement to many individuals pursuing recovery and a valued partner to organizations working to build stronger and healthier communities across Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Will Taylor for his leadership in recovery advocacy and his contributions to strengthening communities throughout this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sincere appreciation for Mr. Taylor's efforts to promote hope, expand awareness, and encourage collaboration in addressing mental health and substance use challenges in Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.